

Acceptance Criteria Document (Updated)

Wages vs Inflation Dashboard | ABS WPI + CPI | Streamlit | Audience: Treasury Policy Analysts

Visual 1 — Chapter 1: The Headline Number Lies

Real wage growth timeline. A dual-line chart plotting wage_growth and inflation_rate quarter by quarter, with the real_wage_growth gap encoded as a filled area. Quarter slider drives dynamic metric card and narrative text updates.

User Story

As a Treasury Policy Adviser, I want to see wage growth and inflation on a single timeline so I can immediately identify every quarter where real purchasing power declined and understand the duration and severity of the gap.

Acceptance Criteria

#	Condition	Result	Notes
AC1.1	Chart displays both wage_growth and inflation_rate as distinct lines from 2023 Q4 to 2025 Q4 with labelled axes and a clear zero baseline	PASS / FAIL	Both lines visible; axes labelled with % and quarter
AC1.2	The real_wage_growth gap area is colour-encoded green when positive and red when negative, with the zero baseline clearly marked	PASS / FAIL	Gap area changes colour at the zero line
AC1.3	Hovering over any data point surfaces a tooltip displaying quarter label, wage_growth value, inflation_rate value and real_wage_growth to one decimal place	PASS / FAIL	Tooltip appears within 300ms; all four fields populated
AC1.4	The three metric cards (Wage Growth, Inflation, Real Wage Delta) update dynamically when the quarter slider is adjusted	PASS / FAIL	Cards update within 500ms of slider movement
AC1.5	A narrative text sentence updates when the quarter slider is adjusted, providing a plain-English interpretation of that quarter (e.g. 'In 2024 Q2, workers lost purchasing power for the third consecutive quarter')	NOT YET MET	Action required

Visual 2 — Chapter 2: Eight Australias, Eight Pay Stories

State wage index bubble chart. Displays wage_index by state for the selected quarter. Each state is a bubble positioned at its capital city lat/long. Hover reveals full state numbers.

User Story

As a Treasury Policy Adviser, I want to compare wage index levels across all eight Australian states and territories so I can identify which jurisdictions are experiencing the most severe real wage decline and prioritise targeted policy intervention.

Acceptance Criteria

#	Condition	Result	Notes
AC2.1	All eight states and territories (NSW, VIC, QLD, SA, WA, TAS, NT, ACT) are represented with correct WPI index values for the selected quarter	PASS / FAIL	Data sourced from ABS WPI Table 2b (634502b)
AC2.2	The national average or spread between highest and lowest state is displayed as a summary callout (e.g. 'Tasmania led with WPI of 163.3, NT sat at 157.3 — a spread of 6.0 index points')	PASS / FAIL	Verify dynamic callout updates with quarter changes
AC2.3	Hovering over any state bubble reveals: state name, wage_index value, and quarter label	PASS / FAIL	Tooltip must appear within 300ms
AC2.4	A one-line clarification note distinguishes wage_index (cumulative level, base 100 in Sep 2008) from wage_growth (quarterly % change) so the audience is not misled	NOT YET MET	Action required. Treasury audience will ask about this distinction.
AC2.5	Colour contrast on bubbles meets WCAG AA standards — verified via contrast checker	PASS / FAIL	Confirm palette at webaim.org/resources/contrastchecker

Visual 3 — Chapter 3: Where the Money Actually Went

CPI category breakdown. Displays cumulative QoQ change across food, housing and transport categories versus headline CPI. Shows which cost pressures are hitting households hardest over the nine-quarter period.

User Story

As a Treasury Policy Adviser, I want to see CPI broken down by expenditure category so I can identify which specific cost pressures (housing, food, transport) are disproportionately eroding real wages and justify targeted sectoral policy recommendations.

Acceptance Criteria

#	Condition	Result	Notes
AC3.1	Chart displays all three category columns (food, housing, transport) plus headline CPI for comparison, with cumulative QoQ values clearly labelled	PASS / FAIL	Current narrative states housing +7.8%, food +6.8%, transport +0.6%, headline +6.4% — verify these figures
AC3.2	Categories that exceed the headline CPI rate are visually distinguished from those below it using pre-attentive colour encoding	PASS / FAIL	Above-average contributors must be immediately

			distinguishable without reading labels
AC3.3	The narrative callout 'Over nine quarters, housing prices climbed a cumulative +7.8%, food +6.8%, and transport +0.6% — against a headline CPI of +6.4%' is prominently displayed	PASS / FAIL	Verify figures match source data
AC3.4	Chart is accessible — colour encoding supplemented by value labels or patterns so category distinction is readable without colour perception	PASS / FAIL	WCAG AA accessibility

Visual 4 — Chapter 4: When Do Real Wages Recover?

What-if scenario panel. Dual sliders for hypothetical quarterly wage growth (0–2%) and quarterly inflation (0–2%). Projects cumulative real wage trajectory for eight future quarters. Includes a recovery target input and plain-English verdict.

User Story

As a Treasury Policy Adviser, I want to model hypothetical wage growth scenarios so I can calculate the exact wage growth rate required to restore positive real outcomes under different inflation conditions and present this as a costed policy recommendation.

Acceptance Criteria

#	Condition	Result	Notes
AC4.1	Wage growth slider operates between 0.00% and 2.00% and inflation slider between 0.00% and 2.00%, both with live numerical readouts	PASS / FAIL	Verify step increments for both sliders
AC4.2	As sliders move, the projected cumulative real wage chart updates in real time with a dashed overlay line visually distinct from the historical data	PASS / FAIL	Overlay must update within 300ms of any slider movement
AC4.3	A 'Reset to actual' button or equivalent restores both sliders to their default baseline values in a single interaction	NOT YET MET	Not currently visible in app — action required
AC4.4	The plain-English verdict sentence (e.g. 'Eight quarters of projection is not enough — at this rate the target would land beyond 2027 Q4') updates dynamically with every slider adjustment	PASS / FAIL	Verify it updates in real time